

Flutter Button Widgets: A Complete Guide

A comprehensive reference for 12 essential button types in Flutter, with code examples and best practices for each.



ElevatedButton

What It Is

A raised button with a background color that provides high visual emphasis through elevation and material design principles.

When to Use

Reserve for primary actions that drive user conversion or complete core tasks. Examples include **Login**, **Submit**, or **Pay Now** buttons.

Code Example

```
ElevatedButton(  
  onPressed: () {  
    print("Elevated Button Pressed");  
  },  
  child: Text("Submit"),  
)
```



TextButton

What It Is

A flat button with no background color or visible elevation. Renders as simple text with interactive ink splash effects.

When to Use

Less important actions or secondary options like **Cancel**, **Skip**, or **Learn More**. Use when minimal visual hierarchy is appropriate.

Code Example

```
TextButton(  
  onPressed: () {  
    print("Text Button  
Pressed");  
  },  
  child: Text("Cancel"),  
)
```



OutlinedButton

A button with a visible border outline that provides medium emphasis between elevated and flat buttons.

What It Is

Styled with a border outline around the button perimeter

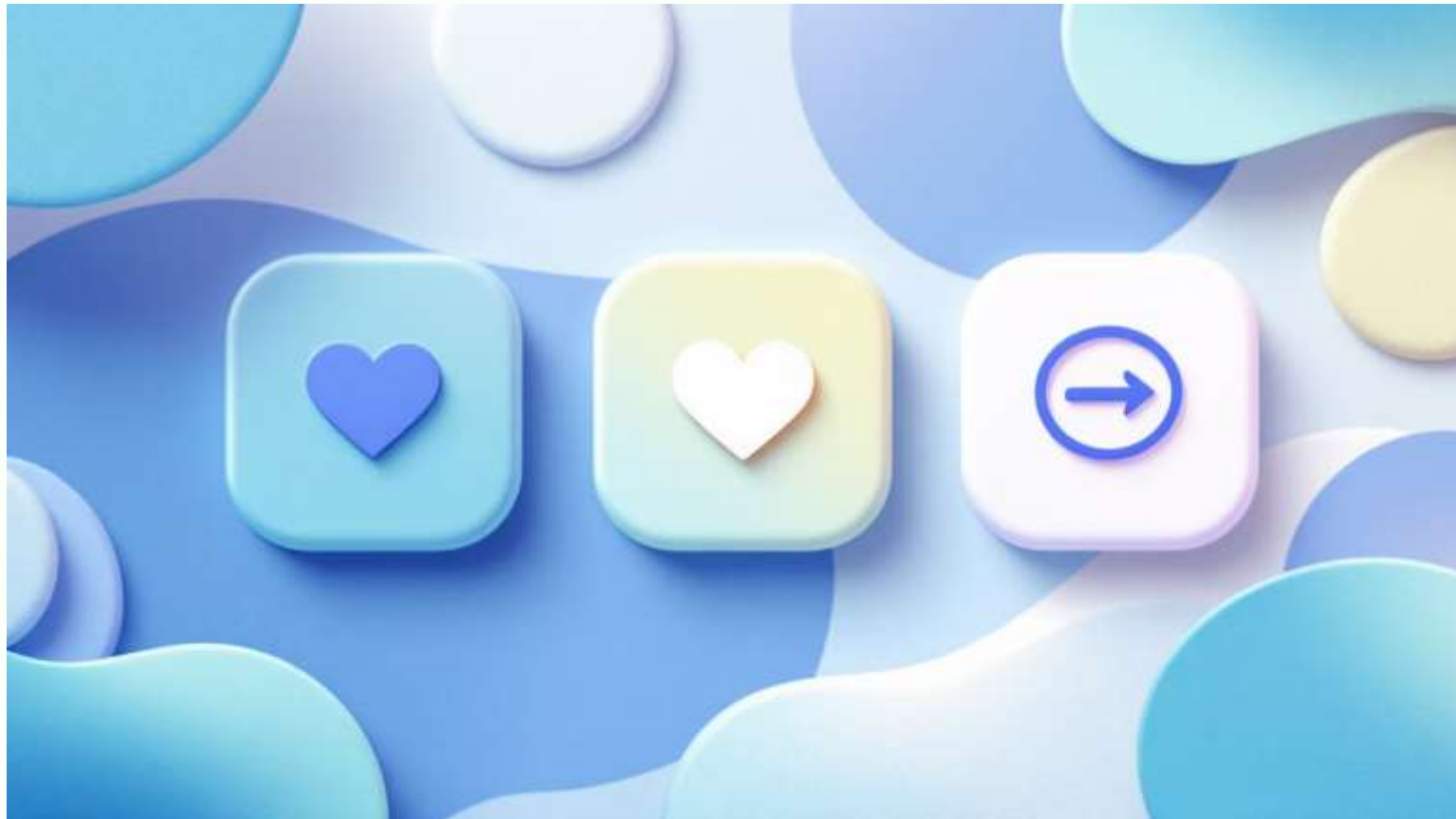
When to Use

Medium emphasis actions like **Register**, **Try Again**, or **View Details**

Code Example

```
OutlinedButton(  
  onPressed: () {  
    print("Outlined Button Pressed");  
  },  
  child: Text("Register"),  
)
```

IconButton



What It Is

A clickable icon-only button with no text label. Perfect for compact actions where the icon provides clear semantic meaning.

When to Use

Compact actions like **Like** , **Share** , or **Delete** . Icon-only buttons save space while maintaining discoverability through familiar symbols.

Code Example

```
IconButton(  
  icon: Icon(Icons.favorite),  
  onPressed: () {  
    print("Icon Button Pressed");  
  },  
)
```



FloatingActionButton (FAB)

What It Is

A circular floating button that typically appears in the bottom-right corner of the screen, following Material Design guidelines.

When to Use

Reserve for the most important action on the screen. Common examples include adding new items (+), creating posts, or opening a camera.

Code Example

```
FloatingActionButton(  
  onPressed: () {  
    print("FAB Pressed");  
  },  
  child: Icon(Icons.add),  
)
```

Icon Variants: Elevated, Text, and Outlined

Each button type can include an icon for enhanced visual clarity and faster user comprehension.



ElevatedButton.icon

High emphasis with icon. Use when icon improves clarity, like **Send** or **Download**.

```
ElevatedButton.icon(  
  onPressed: () {},  
  icon: Icon(Icons.send),  
  label: Text("Send"),  
)
```



TextButton.icon

Flat button with icon. Secondary actions with visual hint, like **Share link** or **Open website**.

```
TextButton.icon(  
  onPressed: () {},  
  icon: Icon(Icons.link),  
  label: Text("Open Link"),  
)
```



OutlinedButton.icon

Medium priority with visual clarity. Perfect for **View Info** or **Help** section actions.

```
OutlinedButton.icon(  
  onPressed: () {},  
  icon: Icon(Icons.info),  
  label: Text("Info"),  
)
```

Selection Menus: Dropdown and Popup

DropDownButton

A select menu button that displays a dropdown list when pressed. Users can choose one option from many predefined choices.

When to Use

- Select country from list
- Choose category
- Pick from enumerated options

Code Example

```
DropDownButton(  
  hint: Text("Select option"),  
  items: ["One", "Two", "Three"]  
    .map((value) => DropdownMenuItem(  
      value: value,  
      child: Text(value),  
    ))  
    .toList(),  
  onChanged: (value) {  
    print(value);  
  },  
)
```

PopupMenuButton

Shows a contextual menu when clicked, typically displayed as a three-dot menu icon. Reveals multiple hidden actions.

When to Use

- Edit or delete options
- Settings menu
- Overflow actions

Code Example

```
PopupMenuButton(  
  onSelect: (value) {  
    print(value);  
  },  
  itemBuilder: (context) => [  
    PopupMenuItem(  
      value: "Edit",  
      child: Text("Edit"),  
    ),  
    PopupMenuItem(  
      value: "Delete",  
      child: Text("Delete"),  
    ),  
  ],  
)
```

Navigation Buttons: Back and Close

1.

BackButton

Automatically navigates back to the previous screen. Typically used inside AppBar or navigation bars.

```
BackButton()
```

2.

CloseButton

Closes the current screen, dialog, or modal. Use for dismissing popups or exiting modal screens.

```
CloseButton()
```



Quick Reference: Button Selection Guide

Choose the right button type based on action priority and visual hierarchy requirements.



Highest Priority

FloatingActionButton or
ElevatedButton for primary
conversion actions



Medium Priority

OutlinedButton or
ElevatedButton.icon for important
but secondary actions



Lowest Priority

TextButton or TextButton.icon for
secondary options and auxiliary
actions

 **Pro Tip:** Limit your screen to one ElevatedButton or FAB. Too many high-emphasis buttons dilute their visual impact and confuse users about the primary action.